

JAMES COX BLACKPOOL PLEASURE BEACH EDITED

Travel Radio Australia and Blackpool in the UK is long been renowned as a center for entertainment in the UK. It's a very historic town and I have with me James Cox from Blackpool Pleasure Beach. Now James, welcome to the program. Thank you. Thanks for me now James.

Tell us about the the Blackpool Pleasure Beach. I believe it's a couple of hotels and you have your own actual theme park within the complex. Yeah, that's right. So we are two hotels, one on the more luxurious side, which is the Boulevard Hotel, and then the Big Blue Hotel, which is perfect for families. And then alongside that, we've got a 42-acre amusement park with some thrilling rides. We have the the big one, which is our most famous ride when we originally opened in 1994. It was the world's biggest, tallest, fastest roller coaster. And then we've got our latest ride icon, which is a double launch coaster, the UK's first, and then in the spring of next year, we have our new ride, which is a 137-foot gyro swing called the Victus. That's arriving in the UK now and being assembled, ready for opening early next year. But on top of that, we've got lots of shows and events so you can see here in front of us. We have an ice show. We have the world's oldest purpose-built ice arena and that whole is home to hot ice. So this is the 90th year of hot ice. The show is called XC Roman numerals for 90 and then we also have Alice Froze in the Wonderland of Dreams. Hot ice show, which is our matinee performance tailored more for the family market and that stems from our Alice in Wonderland ride, which we also have in the park. We're the only park outside of Disney to have an Alice in Wonderland themed ride because our owner was friends with Walt Disney himself and he gave us the plans to be able to build that ride, the exact same one as was built in Disneyland, California. Incredible history at your facility and Blackpool itself has a magnificent heritage. And I know it's the center of shows in the UK and I mean, I'm as well as a reporter, I'm a professional magician and you have the the magicians convention there every year and that is huge. Yeah, we do.

We always say we're a resort within a resort. So we are, you know, our own, our own theme park with our own shows, events in two hotels. But within the resort of Blackpool itself, we've got the Winter Gardens, which is home to, like you say, the magic convention every February or March, but then we also have international dance competition. So we've got a Blackpool Tower Blackpool Tower ballroom, which if anybody watches strictly come dancing, the UK version, main week is always in the tower ballroom and that's because again of the history and the heritage that that ballroom has and the Winter Gardens itself has a lot of history and heritage and we hope we're home to a lot of shows throughout the year. We are a tourist town, we build our visitor attractions based on, you know, reasons to come, how many shows can we get in, what shows can get in, what what? Personalities can get within those shows to try and give people reasons to come and visit Blackpool. So visit us at the theme park to visit and stay in our hotels, the world's tallest roller coaster. That is a magnet for people from all over the world who come to ride it. Tell us about that particular coaster in detail. So it's unfortunately, it's not the world's tallest anymore. But the big one when it opened was the UK the world's very tallest, fastest roller coaster.

If you are a coaster fan of any sort, you know the big one It's kind of it's world-famous and it's synonymous with Blackpool Pleasure Beach It kind of changed the skyline of the resort when it was built We had to get special permission from the airport in order to build it because of its height and proximity to the airport So it's it is the the thing that people think of typically when they think about Blackpool Pleasure Beach and it was open in 1994 it's still going strong today We replace lots of its track year and what year as a continued investment to ensure that we keep up with that thrilling factor that It provides and you know when I look at my surveys I'm the marketing guy when I look at my my surveys and what's the top? You know reasons you visit big ones always there as a staple at either number one or two At the height of the the main drop that must be enormous. It's 237 feet.

So it's very tall indeed Yes, it's you feel it when you're going over the top and also what's unique with us and our location is that we're on the seafront So our drop is aimed over the seafront So a lot of Greenfield sites like Thorpe Park or other sites around Orlando, etc You're just tall in the middle of a park whereas our drop is positioned so that as you go over you are staring into the Sea just to give you that any thrill factor to to make your mind almost play play a trick on you But it definitely adds to the to the value of going on the ride and the seafront there It's iconic with all of its neon lights and if people never been to Blackpool before it's a bit Las Vegas II, isn't it? Official slogan has always been the Las Vegas of the north meaning the Las Vegas of the north of England And that stems from like you say the home of entertainment We've got the Blackpool illuminations, which are world famous again the oldest light show in the world They've been going since gas lamps lights back in the day You know when we started the illuminations that was literally somebody going from post to post lighting them up with a gas lighter Whereas now it's miles and miles of world famous lights There's a huge switch on in September and they run right through to January again just creating more and more reasons for people to visit Blackpool and to come and see what the town has to offer for For everyone there's something for everyone in Blackpool whether it shows or it's magic whether it's ice skating shows theme parks Blackpool tower lots of pool tower ballroom. There's something for everyone Now apart from your fabulous restaurants you have at Blackpool Pleasure Beach Can you give us a couple of your places in Blackpool that you would recommend a bit out of the way a bit? Secret for the locals that you should that visitors might want to jump into Yeah, so we're very close to a place for living sentence in Blackpool, which is the more Luxurious place on the coast. It's the retirement home of a lot of wealthy individuals a lot of ex-footballers and that also that has a lot of great restaurants, so it's purpose-built around the clientele that They live there.

So I definitely recommend living st. Anne's. There's also lots of little hidden gems So there's a place called not your Arnie's ice cream Which is been serving ice cream since the early 1900s same family still open it still own it and that that they only do one flavor the cues that that gets because of its Name and reputation within the town not just with locals But with visitors who come year-on-year and have built up a look for the place that be another recommendation of mine Yeah, and how can people find out more about Blackpool Pleasure Beach online James? Yes,

just head to the website blackpoolpleasurebeach.com You'll see everything that we've got going on for 2026 and beyond You'll be able to see all of our shows and events and also take a look at our two hotels Thank you very much for being on the program James Cox from Blackpool Pleasure Beach Limited in the UK head over to their site and you can definitely have a lot of fun and a lot of excitement Yeah, this is like I say something for everyone in Blackpool and everyone who goes typically enjoys place Thanks, Shane.

Cheers. Thanks, Jeff